

CHAPTER 1

Introduction



This chapter is part of the PINK reading tour. See Figure 1-1 for alternative reading tours.

Architecture is a fantastic profession. But I am not talking about the architecture of buildings or cities (which is also great, by the way). I am talking about the profession of Enterprise Architecture.

With the tools we have, we as architects can help organizations translate their strategy into an executable whole. We can help them by giving them insight into the implications of implementing such a strategy. We can also interpret those implications in a way that is understandable to a wide range of stakeholders. For each level of an organization, we can create a visualization that gives those stakeholders a clear picture of the impact that proposed changes have or will have. We can do all of this because we have several tools at our disposal.

One such tool is architecture frameworks. For us as architects, these are reference works. They describe the outlines of how we can map the changes needed for and by an organization and how to interpret them. Architecture frameworks help us determine what impact these changes will have on achieving the desired outcomes and thus the intended goals. These frameworks provide us with a great tool, and because of them, we don't have to reinvent the proverbial wheel. We can tap into the knowledge and expertise of countless people who have gone through the trouble of

figuring things out for us, trying them out, testing them, and capturing them in the frameworks. All we have to do is follow them and adapt them to our needs and specific situations or challenges.

The TOGAF Standard is known as *the world's leading architecture framework* and has been used by tens of thousands of architects for decades [1]. This is not surprising because it is a very complete and comprehensive framework. All the ins and outs that we as architects could possibly face are described and explained in the framework.

The reason that I wanted to write a book about the TOGAF Standard is not because I thought that the TOGAF Standard was incomplete or lacking something. Quite the contrary. It may actually seem overly complete in some areas. Perhaps a bit cumbersome in its practical application. And maybe even a little inconsistent in some respects. No, the main reason for writing this book is that I believe that the TOGAF Standard is a very applicable framework that, in my opinion, has not yet been properly applied by the profession. I believe this is because not everyone knows or understands exactly *how to apply* the framework. Partly because of the amount of information in the framework and the sometimes fuzzy (or even academic and stale) way in which that information is explained, many architects give up and do not use the approach described in the TOGAF Standard. And that's a shame.

I hope to present an approach - a *practical* approach - that clarifies the methodology in such a way that more architects will start using (at least parts of) the framework. Because that is what the TOGAF Standard is all about: using the parts that apply to your own situation or organization and applying the method in a way that makes it work for the architectural challenges.

This book is certainly not a one-to-one description of everything that's in the TOGAF Standard. It covers the most important parts of the framework, supplemented by additional topics that I felt could help paint a complete enough picture of how to use the framework. I have also included certain areas that I believed needed more context and

explanation. If you're looking for a complete listing of every possible topic, I suggest you read the TOGAF Standard itself, which is a good idea on its own. The primary purpose of this book is to help you master the most important parts of the world's leading architecture framework.

The book focuses on the *practical application* of the TOGAF Framework. This framework consists of a substantial number of fundamental components that are important for building a solid Enterprise Architecture. Series Guides highlight specific topics or present additional aspects of the architecture.

The TOGAF Framework and its fundamental components are designed to be durable and stable. The Series Guides offer industry-specific, architectural-style, purpose-specific, and problem-specific guidance on how to use the framework. They also contain additional information on a variety of architecture-related topics. The Series Guides are expected to evolve the fastest of all the TOGAF documentation. Due to their rapid growth, The Open Group has decided to no longer include the supporting guides as a permanent part of the TOGAF Framework. With the release of *The TOGAF Standard, 10th Edition*¹, The Open Group divided the Standard into two sections: *Fundamental Content* (see Chapter 3, Section 3.2) and supplementary information on architecture-specific topics, known as *Series Guides* (see Chapter 3, Section 3.3).

The TOGAF Framework (consisting of the aforementioned Fundamental Content) remains the essential scaffolding across industries, domains, and styles. It is therefore the focus of this book. Some of the topics covered in the Series Guides are also covered in this book, but as The Open Group itself states:

Not all the TOGAF Series Guides will be relevant in every situation [2].

¹ *The TOGAF Standard, 10th Edition*, was released in April 2022.

However, Enterprise Architects who are planning the deployment of the TOGAF Standard should be aware of the guidance available.

As I said earlier, this book will focus primarily on the TOGAF Framework, with the addition of those components and/or Series Guides that have proven to be essential in guiding architects in the implementation of Enterprise Architecture.

If you were to summarize the TOGAF Standard in a nutshell, it would boil down to the *establishment and implementation* of the Architecture Capability. This capability is implemented by one or more *architecture roles*, which in turn use architecture *skills* and *competencies*.

Architecture work begins with a thorough understanding of the organization's goals, such as improving customer experience, accelerating digital transformation, or optimizing operations. This foundational step, *understanding business needs*, involves collecting and analyzing both business and technology objectives.

The next step is to *design the architecture*. With a clear understanding of business needs, the architecture design process begins. This includes data management strategies, application integration methods, and the selection of appropriate technologies, all aimed at supporting rapid development and efficient digital delivery cycles.

The TOGAF Standard can then be used to develop a flexible *implementation roadmap* that emphasizes agility and iterative progress. Tasks are prioritized to ensure a seamless and adaptable transition, with a focus on *delivering value* early and consistently. This is called *implementation planning*.

Finally, there is *governance and execution*. This involves implementing governance mechanisms to maintain alignment with the *architectural vision*. The TOGAF Standard recognizes the need for continuous evolution of the architecture to quickly adapt to changing business needs.

By following the structured phases of the Architecture Development Method, organizations can effectively develop and implement an Enterprise Architecture that is responsive to dynamic business

environments. It's important to note that not everything in the TOGAF Standard needs to be used in its entirety. Tailoring the framework is a must.

Perhaps a little too bluntly stated for some, but that is what it comes down to. If you keep this in mind when applying the TOGAF Standard, the framework suddenly feels a lot less overwhelming.

1.1. Why This Book

As I mentioned at the beginning of this chapter, the TOGAF Standard is the most widely used and applied Enterprise Architecture framework in the world.

The TOGAF Framework is and remains the essential scaffolding across industries, domains, and styles [3].

Despite the fact that the TOGAF Standard is considered the *de facto* standard worldwide, there is also criticism of the framework. Criticism that, in my opinion, is mostly unfounded.

Some quotes collected over the years:

“Real examples demonstrating the actual practical usage of TOGAF's recommendations are missing.”

“TOGAF's prescriptions are vague and inarticulate since it only states that the ADM should be adapted without specifying how.”

“Using TOGAF can be best explained as studying TOGAF and then doing something else instead.”

The main criticisms of the framework are its *lack of real added value* and its *vague prescriptions*, which make practitioners feel more or less compelled (or forced) not to use the framework for the reasons mentioned.

The people who created the framework invested a great deal of time and effort into developing a useful tool from which others can benefit.

In this book, I aim to refute these arguments for not using the framework. I therefore provide examples of the *practical* application of the TOGAF Standard. This will demonstrate the added value of the framework and how to interpret the so-called vague prescriptions mentioned above. These examples come from daily practice and are easy to understand and use.

I am not saying that there is nothing left to be desired in terms of the framework. I also see room for improvement in some areas. For example, the argument that I myself can agree with is that the TOGAF Standard mostly describes the *what* and not the *how*.

The description of the phases of the Architecture Development Method focuses on recommendations on *what* may be done to define and deploy an Enterprise Architecture.

Guidance on *how* to do what is specified can be found in the TOGAF Series Guides [2].

A lot of time and attention is spent in the framework interpreting all sorts of things that *must* or *can* be done to achieve an Enterprise Architecture implementation. However, describing *how* implementers of the framework should actually go about doing this is less well articulated, even in the aforementioned Series Guides. An omission, in my opinion.

I have mentioned this on a number of occasions when I had the opportunity to have conversations with people from The Open Group. So far, it has not led to a change in the framework's approach.

This is one of the reasons why I decided to write this book. With this book I want to show *how* the TOGAF Standard can be used to achieve an Enterprise Architecture implementation. Practical and pragmatic. With powerful examples.

By doing so, the third quote above can also be debunked. After reading this book, everyone will be able to apply the theory of the TOGAF Standard in a practical and pragmatic way. There will no longer be any reason to *study TOGAF and then do something else instead*.

With this book, I enable the reader to use the world's leading architecture framework as it was intended to be used: *practical* and *pragmatic*, but also *tailored* to the situation.

A lot of care and thought has gone into this book. I realize that nothing is ever perfect, and this book is no different. If you find any errors or typos, please report them. You can find instructions on how to do this on my website: <https://eawheel.com/books/errata/>.

1.2. Who This Book Is For

This book is first and foremost for architects. People who have been practicing the profession of architecture for many years. It's written for people who know TOGAF or for those who have at least heard of the framework. It's for architects with strong opinions about the TOGAF Standard, for those that say they don't use the framework but fail to give a *solid argument* as to why they don't use it.

This book is really for *two kinds of people*:

- Those who **have** reviewed or read the TOGAF Standard
- Those who **have not** reviewed or read the TOGAF Standard

For those who have: In all likelihood, this group of people does not apply the TOGAF Standard in their daily work. Or at the very least, they think they do not. This may be because the theory described in the framework is not sufficiently supported by meaningful examples or situations from practice. Or it may be because the theory is too vague in some areas, making it difficult to apply in real life. To this group of people I would like to say: this is *definitely* a book for you!

For those who haven't: For the group of people who have not yet had the time and opportunity to familiarize themselves with the TOGAF Standard, this book is an excellent starting point. It explains the theory of the framework in a practical and pragmatic way, using clear examples and real-world scenarios. The group of people who have not yet embraced the framework may be put off by the amount of theory or by the fact that in some situations the framework is talked about in a less positive way. With this book, I hope to address both of these concerns.

The theory laid out in the TOGAF Standard is extensive, to say the least. And it needs to be, since it is the *blueprint* for Enterprise Architecture. The scope of Enterprise Architecture is broad and has many different aspects. All of these aspects must be described in detail in a framework in such a way that there is little (if any) ambiguity. With this book, I offer the reader the opportunity to absorb this theory in an accessible way. I translate the theory from the TOGAF Standard in a practical and pragmatic way so that it becomes highly accessible to everyone.

Mastering the TOGAF® Standard is a book for anyone who wants to learn how to use the world's leading architecture framework.

1.3. How to Read This Book

The book provides a *practical translation* of the major topics that exist in the TOGAF Standard. This wealth of information is complemented by a brief history of the framework and its evolution over time. An explanation of the framework's composition is also included in this book.

My goal with each topic is not just to paint a picture of a certain approach that can be taken. I wanted to describe not only the *what*, as is already expertly done in the TOGAF Standard itself, but more importantly the *how*. Therefore, I have tried to provide each major topic in the framework with clear steps to support its implementation or to clarify exactly what is meant by a particular topic. I also packed the book with the necessary illustrations to support the topics. I felt it was important to not only describe the theory, but to bring that theory to life with easy-to-understand examples.

In addition to the standard route of moving through the book in its entirety, there are a number of alternative routes you can take. These alternative routes allow you to focus on specific content:

- Learn about **the very basics** of the TOGAF Standard.
- Learn about **the major concepts** of the TOGAF Standard.
- Dive **into the details**.
- Content you **won't find easily elsewhere**.

Figure 1-1 illustrates the different reading tours and their content.

For example, if you are one of the people who **has** reviewed or read the TOGAF Standard, you may decide to read the book by following the blue or gold reading tour as shown in Figure 1-1. In this way, you can dive into the rich details of the framework or catch up on content that you may not easily find elsewhere.

Another way to read the book is to follow the green reading tour. This will allow you to learn about the most important concepts contained in the TOGAF Standard. If you are just interested in brushing up on the basics, then the pink reading tour is the way to go.

Each chapter is preceded by the following reference to the reading tour(s) of which the chapter is a part.



This chapter is part of the PINK reading tour. See Figure 1-1 for alternative reading tours.

However, if you are one of those people who **have not** reviewed or read the TOGAF Standard, I recommend that you read the book *in its entirety*. Reading the entire book from cover to cover will reveal all the ingenious relationships between the various parts of the framework. This is, of course, the best way to read *Mastering the TOGAF® Standard*.

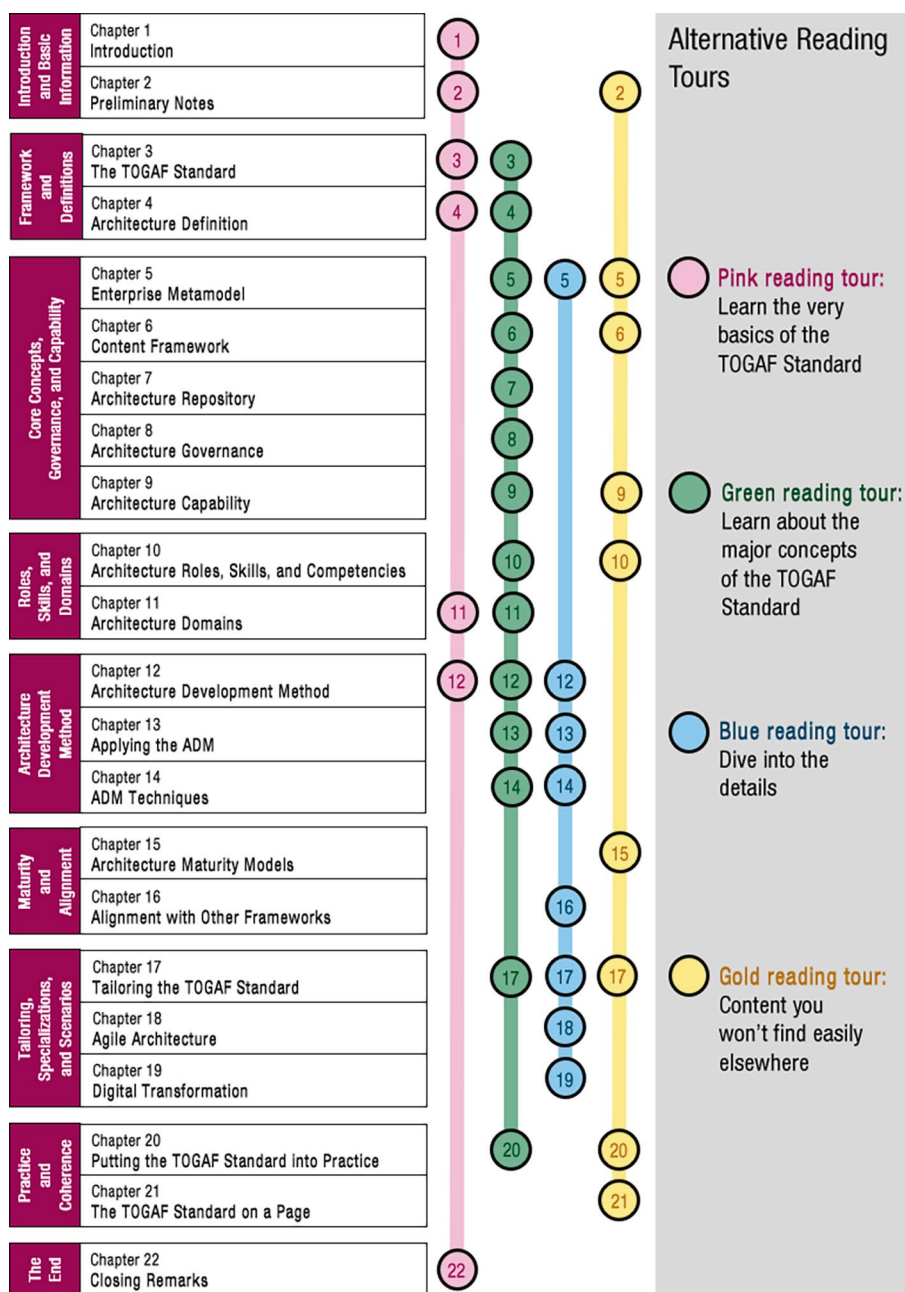


Figure 1-1. Alternative reading tours

Throughout the book, I have used quotes and definitions, personal experiences, references (indicated by a number between brackets: [13]), and suggestions for further reading to paint as complete a picture as possible.

Personal experiences or comments are indicated by a specific type of formatting, such as the one used in this sentence.

In the book, I used figures to explain certain topics or situations. In some cases, the amount of information contained in such a figure can be very extensive, so it may be at the expense of readability. Therefore, all images used in this book can be downloaded in high resolution from my website:

<https://eawheel.com/books/media/>

This book aims to explain the TOGAF Standard. It is not a book about ArchiMate or modeling ethics. Therefore, the diagrams in this book do not strictly adhere to ArchiMate modeling guidelines. The diagrams are for illustrative purposes only. However, to maintain recognizability, the diagrams use the familiar ArchiMate color scheme.



Further Reading

Tips for further reading are indicated by a book icon and are listed in these Further Reading information boxes. The tips either reference documents found in the TOGAF Library or point to online resources.



Whenever a piece of information needs (or could use) an abbreviated step-by-step approach, the steps icon is used. The steps described in this particular block are short and to the point.

All names used in examples, artifacts, and case scenarios in this book are fictitious and do not refer to actual persons or organizations.